

COTS Crib Kiosk — PC Setup Session Notes

Last updated: 2026-03-13

Machine Details

- **Hardware:** HP touchscreen all-in-one (Lenovo ThinkCentre connected via HP touch display)
 - **OS:** Windows 7 (Version 6.1.7601)
 - **User profile:** `C:\Users\Traxis-COTs\`
 - **Dropbox:** Successfully logged in
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Status

Step	Status
Install Dropbox	✅ Done — logged in
Selective Sync (only folder 17)	❑ To do
Install Python	⚠️ Installed but PATH not set
pip install flask requests	❑ To do
Test Flask server	❑ To do
Test start_kiosk.vbs	❑ To do
Set up auto-start on boot	❑ To do
Auto-login on boot (optional)	❑ To do
Disable Task Manager (optional)	❑ To do

Python Notes

- **Required version:** 3.8.10 (last version with Windows 7 support + Windows binary installer)
- **Download URL:** <https://www.python.org/downloads/release/python-3810/>
- **File to download:** Windows x86-64 executable installer
- **Critical:** Must check "Add Python to PATH" on first installer screen
- Python 3.9+ does NOT support Windows 7

Python PATH fix batch file

If Python is installed but not on PATH, run `fix_python_path.bat` (see below).

Batch Files (save these to the cots-kiosk folder)

fix_python_path.bat

Fixes Python PATH if the installer was run without checking "Add Python to PATH". Run this once from Command Prompt, then close and reopen CMD.

```
@echo off
echo Fixing Python PATH...

set PYPATH=C:\Users\Traxis-COTs\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python38
set PYSCRIPTS=C:\Users\Traxis-COTs\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python38\Scripts

if exist "%PYPATH%\python.exe" (
    echo Found Python at %PYPATH%
    setx PATH "%PATH%;%PYPATH%;%PYSCRIPTS%"
    echo PATH updated. Close and reopen Command Prompt, then run: python --versio
) else (
    echo Python not found at expected path.
    echo Searching...
    dir C:\Users\Traxis-COTs\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\
    echo.
    echo Edit this bat file with the correct folder name above and run again.
)
pause
```

install_packages.bat

Run this after Python PATH is confirmed working.

```
@echo off
echo Installing Flask and requests...
pip install flask requests
echo.
echo Done. If you see errors above, Python PATH may still be incorrect.
pause
```

verify_setup.bat

Run this to confirm everything is ready before launching the kiosk.

```
@echo off
echo === Python version ===
python --version
echo.
echo === Checking flask install ===
python -c "import flask; print('Flask OK:', flask.__version__)"
echo.
echo === Checking requests install ===
python -c "import requests; print('Requests OK:', requests.__version__)"
echo.
pause
```

Windows 7 Caveats

- Windows 7 is end-of-life (no security updates since Jan 2020)
- Chrome has dropped official Win 7 support but may still run
- Python 3.8.10 is the last version with Win 7 support
- `gpedit.msc` (disable Task Manager) requires Win Pro or Enterprise — check which edition this machine is
- Consider upgrading to Windows 10 long-term

Next Steps (in order)

1. Reinstall Python 3.8.10 with PATH checkbox checked (or run `fix_python_path.bat`)
 2. Verify with: `python --version` → should say `Python 3.8.10`
 3. Run `install_packages.bat` (or `pip install flask requests`)
 4. Set up Dropbox Selective Sync — only sync folder 17
 5. Verify cots-kiosk folder path: `D:\Dropbox\MACHINE COMM Traxis\Proshop Automation and Claude Projects\17. COTS - Tools Crib Kiosk\cots-kiosk\`
 6. Test Flask: `cd` into cots-kiosk, run `python app.py` , open Chrome → `http://localhost:5000`
 7. Test `start_kiosk.vbs` — double-click it, verify Chrome opens fullscreen
 8. Add `start_kiosk.vbs` shortcut to Startup folder (`shell:startup`)
 9. Reboot and verify auto-start
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Key Paths

Item	Path
Kiosk code	<code>D:\Dropbox\MACHINE COMM Traxis\Proshop Automation and Claude Projects\17. COTS - Tools Crib Kiosk\cots-kiosk\</code>
Log file	<code>cots-kiosk\kiosk_launcher.log</code>
Python (expected)	<code>C:\Users\Traxis-COTs\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python38\</code>
Startup folder	<code>shell:startup</code>